allows you to spin up an EC2 instance faster, because the boot process does not include deployment steps.

15.3 Deploying customized AMIs created by Packer

In this section, we present using customized Amazon Machine Images (AMIs), also called *immutable servers*. An immutable server starts from an image and is ready to go. To deploy a change, a new image is created, and the old server is replaced by a new one based on the new image.

Because a new image is needed for every change, it is advisable to automate the process of creating it. Usually, we stick to the tools AWS provides. However, we cannot recommend the EC2 Image Builder offered by AWS because it is complicated to use and doesn't seem to be designed to build images when you own the source code. Instead, we recommend Packer, a tool provided by HashiCorp, which is very easy to use. Figure 15.4 illustrates how Packer works, as described here:

1. Launch an EC2 instance.
2. Connect to the EC2 instance via the Systems Manager.
3. Run the provisioner script.
4. Stop the EC2 instance.
5. Create an AMI.
6. Terminate the EC2 instance.